

Reading the Trajectory Sparklines

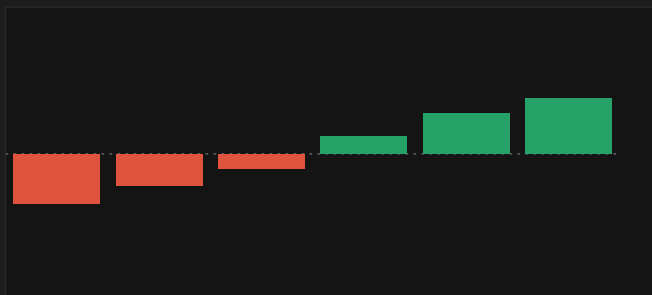
Mode 10 Selection Tool · SMC Quant Pro · field guide

When you draw a selection over a span of buckets, the stats box now carries three trajectory sparklines – tiny inline charts that show how the order-flow balance evolves left-to-right across the buckets in your selection. They answer a question the aggregate numbers cannot: not how much overall, but where within the move the balance shifted.

Read these as description, not prediction. A sparkline shows you where effort or positioning changed – a fact about what already happened in the flow. It does not forecast the next move. (Forward-return testing on 1m SOL found the flow is descriptive, not predictive.) Use the crossover as context – “this is where the balance turned” – never as a standalone entry signal.

How every sparkline is built

All three work identically. Once you can read one, you can read all of them – only the quantity and the colors change.



Each bar = one bucket (time order, left→right).
Height = magnitude of the balance.
Color = which side leads that bucket.
The dashed midline = true zero (perfectly balanced).
The color flip = the crossover – where the lead changes hands.

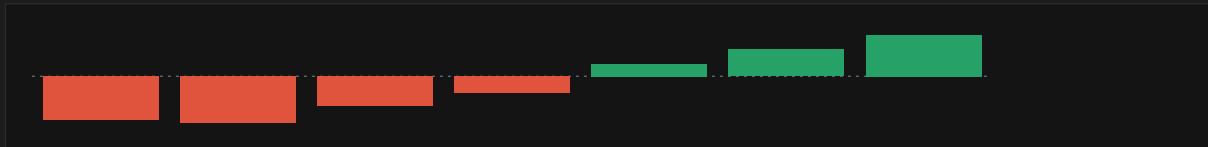
Bars above the midline	the bar's side is winning in that bucket; bars below = the other side winning.
Deeper / taller bar	a stronger imbalance that bucket. The tallest bar is the most one-sided moment.
The color flip point	the crossover – the bucket where the lead passes from one side to the other. This is the moment you're hunting for.
Zero is pinned to the midline	the flip always sits at the true balance point, not at the selection's average. Heights auto-scale to the selection, but the crossover stays honest.

Two practical limits: a selection under 5 buckets hides the sparkline (too few points to mean anything – the aggregate E/R already covers it), and a very long selection is down-sampled to ~40 bars (buckets are binned, so the shape and crossover survive, just coarser).

The three trajectories

1. E/R – the effort trajectory

Where: EFFORT section, labeled E/R → | Plots: buyer E/R – seller E/R (per bucket)



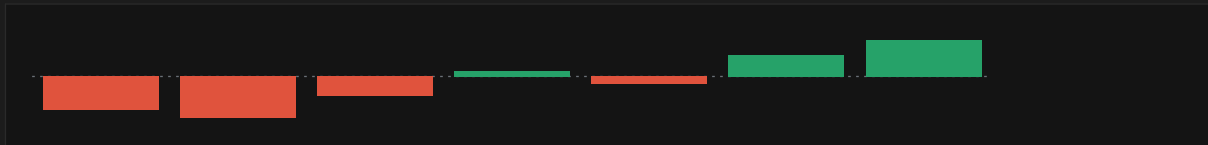
Answers: “Where did the sellers' effort stop producing downward price?” This is effort vs. result – it rises when a side pushes hard and moves price, but a side pushing hard while price stalls (absorption) is the early tell that momentum is dying – something raw buy/sell delta misses.

■ Green = buyers leading the effort battle · ■ Red = sellers leading.

In the example above: sellers push hardest at the start (deep red), their effort fades as price stalls, then the bar flips green – that flip is where buyers overtake.

2. Op L/S – the initiation trajectory

Where: POSITIONING section, labeled Op L/S → | Plots: opening-long – opening-short (per bucket)



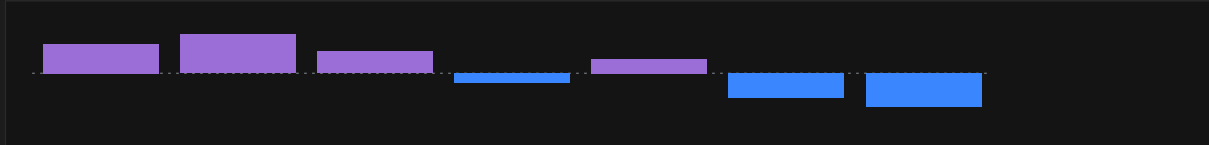
Answers: “Where did fresh positioning turn?” Tracks new positions being initiated. In a move down: heavy short-initiation, then it fades and long-initiation picks up – the point where new money switches sides.

■ Green = long-initiation leads · ■ Red = short-initiation leads. (Same green/red bull/bear sense as E/R.)

In the example above: new shorts dominate early, then the signal gets choppy around the midline before long-initiation takes over – note the small counter-bar, typical of this metric's noise.

3. Cl L/S – the exit trajectory

Where: POSITIONING section, labeled Cl L/S → | Plots: closing-long – closing-short (per bucket)



Answers: “Who is exiting, and where does that shift?” Tracks positions being closed. In a move down: longs getting stopped out, then shorts covering / taking profit – a confirmation read more than a turn signal.

■ Purple = closing-long lead (longs exiting) · ■ Blue = closing-short lead (shorts exiting). Deliberately a different palette so exits never blur with the green/red opens & effort.

In the example above: longs are bailing early (purple), then it flips to shorts covering (blue) – the purple→blue flip marks the handover in who's exiting.

Color cheat-sheet

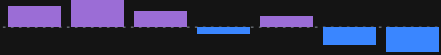
■ Green	buyers / long-initiation leading (E/R, Op L/S)
■ Red	sellers / short-initiation leading (E/R, Op L/S)
■ Purple	closing-long leading – longs exiting (Cl L/S only)
■ Blue	closing-short leading – shorts exiting (Cl L/S only)
■ Gray	balanced – bar sits at the midline, no clear lead

The three labels (E/R →, Op L/S →, Cl L/S →) plus the purple/blue palette on the exit line are what keep the three trajectories distinct at a glance. The colors reuse the box's existing 4-vector convention (opL green, opS red, cLL purple, cLS blue), so they stay consistent with the rest of the readout.

Worked example: reading a move down

You select a span covering a sell-off that stalls and reverses. Reading the three sparklines together tells a fuller story than any one alone:

E/R →		Sellers' effort peaks then fades while price stalls; flips green. The effort handover.
Op L/S →		Short-initiation dries up; long-initiation builds. New money switching sides.

Cl L/S →		Longs stop out, then shorts cover. Confirmation the down-leg is unwinding.
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The synthesis: when the effort flip (E/R), the initiation turn (Op L/S), and the exit handover (Cl L/S) line up around the same region, you're looking at a well-supported shift in flow. When they disagree – say effort flips but initiation doesn't – the shift is shallower than it looks. Either way: this describes what the flow did, and you bring your own judgment for what to do next.

A note on noise

The E/R trajectory is built from trade-exact data (every trade carries a price and side), so it's relatively clean. The two positioning trajectories (Op L/S, Cl L/S) are built from the 4-vector, which is derived from a ~5-second open-interest poll sprayed across trades by timing – not an exact per-trade measurement. So expect them to be choppier: a stray counter-colored bar in an otherwise one-sided run is usually that timing noise, not a real micro-reversal. They are shown honestly (never artificially smoothed) so you can judge their readability yourself. If a positioning sparkline looks like a coin-toss blur on your selections, trust the cleaner E/R line and the aggregate numbers instead.

Three trajectories – effort (E/R), initiation (Op L/S), exit (Cl L/S). Each shows where the balance turned across your selection. Descriptive context, read at a glance.